

49th ANNIVERSARY

TURNING POINTS
DEFENCE & SPACE

CRITICAL FACTOR
INS *Arihant* at the ship-building centre in Visakhapatnam

INS ARIHANT, 2016

THIRD ARM OF THE TRIAD

A triumph of indigenous mastery of complex military technology, INS *Arihant* completes India's nuclear triad and bolsters India's maritime security at a time of aggressive Chinese naval expansion

BY PRADIP R. SAGAR

Excepting its proven excellence in ballistic missiles, India has met its needs for cutting-edge military hardware either through imports or licensed manufacturing under transfer of technology deals. The emergence of INS *Arihant*—India's first indigenous nuclear submarine—therefore, has to be counted as one of the country's finest-ever achievements in cracking complex military knowhow. Designed by the Defence Research and Development Organisation (DRDO), Arihant was launched on July 26, 2009, and commissioned on August 23, 2016. Its development highlights the country's commitment to self-reliance in defence and